Maharaja's rule. Qadeer was arrested and put on trial in Srinagar on 6 June 1931.

On 13 July 1931, while Qadeer's trial was on in the Srinagar central jail, the police opened fire on an unruly mob of Qadeer supporters, killing 22 demonstrators. The agitation then spread throughout the rest of the state. The Maharaja was convinced that a senior minister in his court, a British bureaucrat named Wakefield, was the brain behind this agitation and immediately dismissed him. The Maharaja believed that the agitation was a pre-planned attack on him; a punishment for taking a contradictory stance against the British, at the Round Table Conference in London, in 1930. G. E. C. Wakefield was replaced by a distinguished Kashmiri Pandit, Sir Hari Kishan Kaul, who was made the state's Prime Minister.

The Rise of Abdullah and the Mirwaiz

The agitation throughout Kashmir was spearheaded by two men: the religious leader Mirwaiz Mohammad Yusuf Shah and his protégé, a young schoolmaster called Sheikh Mohammed Abdullah. The agitation led by these two men with the support of other Muslim leaders in the country forced the Maharaja to set up a commission of enquiry that would investigate this violence. The commission, presided over by Sir Bertram Glancy, asked Hari Singh to create a constitution for the state which would enshrine freedom of speech, expression and assembly for its inhabitants. At the same time, Sheikh Abdullah and the Mirwaiz were imprisoned in the Srinagar central jail; their arrest added to their popularity and they found a dedicated population of followers in the state. In 1934, the promised constitution was introduced in the state of Kashmir. This was the first time that the government imposed a constitution upon a princely state. The document guaranteed certain fundamental rights and forced Hari Singh to concentrate on his subjects and their political and economic needs.

Just as Pratap Singh's political freedoms were heavily constrained,[15] Hari Singh's powers were also brought to check by the imposition of the constitution. The introduction of the constitution enabled some of the